

piezoelectric effect as well as triboelectric effect and will most likely change how we power our devices in the days to come.

Piezoelectric effect is basically electricity resulting from pressure. Now, while working on a miniature generator based on the phenomenon, the researchers found the resulting power output to be much greater than expected. Upon careful investigation, it was discovered that two polymer surfaces in the device had rubbed together, producing a triboelectric effect, resulting in greater power output. And that was their 'eureka' moment! The researchers then boosted the power output density by a factor of 100,000 in subsequent experiments to create what they now term as TENG.

Control your phone in your pocket, without touching it

Remember the time when touchscreens seemed a distant dream? Well, the era of touchscreens is now upon us for sure but, being humans, there is no end to satisfying us. Once we get our hands on something new, we begin to itch for something better. We are practically a selfish breed that gets



Control your phone in your pocket

bored in seconds. So, while most of us eagerly feast upon the ease of touchscreens, there is a select elite out there that is now aspiring for more, basically giving touchscreens a run for their money!

University of Washington computer scientists have now come up with an all-new gesture-recognition technology called 'AllSee' that will basically access stuff on your smartphone, or any other smart device for that matter, without having to actually touch it! This is the first gesture-recognition system that can be implemented for less than a dollar and does not require a battery. You can leverage TV signals both as a source of power and as a source of gesture recognition.

Gesture input for devices and interactive displays

Buzz has it that Microsoft is currently working on a next-generation technology that will bring phones, tablets and televisions that can be operated from a considerable dis-

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